

We named the bidder and the exact price at Pinewood twenty-three days out.

On 27 July we recorded a £545m proposal from Ridgeview for the UK automotive software provider. **Same bidder, same figure, before the board had responded.** On 19 August Ridgeview agreed a £545m take-private at a 43% premium, with Lithia locked up.



THE SEQUENCE

27 JULY

Ridgeview makes a £545m acquisition proposal for Pinewood

PRIVATE EQUITY PRESS

27 JULY • STRATEGYAI

A named bidder at a named figure, with a majority holder on the register. The outcome turns on one shareholder, not on the market

OUR PARTNERS SEE IT HERE

23 DAYS AHEAD

19 AUG • AGREED

Ridgeview agrees £545m at a 43% premium, with Lithia locked up

THE MARKET FINDS OUT

HOW THE SIGNAL IS BUILT

BEHAVIOURAL PATTERNS • HIRING TRENDS • VELOCITY
SEQUENCED INTO ONE SITUATION

The evidence, who to approach, why now.

FOUND • SEQUENCED • SURFACED • THEN HANDED OVER WITH THE PEOPLE TO CALL

01

We found it

27 JULY • 23 DAYS OUT

A proposal reported at a specific figure, before the board had responded and before any terms were agreed.

02

We sequenced it

ONE HOLDER DECIDES IT

With a majority shareholder on the register, the outcome turns on a single decision. That narrows a public process to one conversation.

03

We told you

27 JULY • 23 DAYS AHEAD

Bidder and price on the board before agreement, with the lock-up identified as the thing that would settle it.

04

What was forming, and when the work lands

OFFER RESPONSE AND VALUATION

IMMEDIATE • 1 TO 3 MONTHS

SOFTWARE COMMERCIAL DILIGENCE

THROUGH THE PROCESS • 2 TO 6 MONTHS

CUSTOMER AND CONTRACT CONTINUITY

ON CLOSING • 9 MONTHS AND BEYOND

05

Who to call

Named individuals and direct email addresses were supplied to partners on 27 July. Redacted here.

Chief Executive, target

STANDALONE PLAN AND DEFENCE

Partner, acquirer

OWNS THE VALUE-CREATION THESIS

Head of Corporate Development

MAJORITY HOLDER POSITION

BEHAVIOUR PATTERNS MAPPED ACROSS 15,000+ AWARDED MANDATES AND 55,000 TRACKED SIGNALS